ORCID in Action

Understanding ORCID in Africa

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ORCID's Place Within the African Research Ecosystem

The African research landscape is **vibrant, growing**, and **increasingly collaborative**. However, it also faces **structural challenges**:

- Researcher name ambiguity (multiple spellings, name changes, cultural naming variations)
- Limited visibility of African scholarship in global indexes
- Fragmented research information systems
- Underrepresentation in global research analytics
- Mobility of researchers across institutions and countries

Open Science FAIR Principle (Findable, Accessible, Interoperable, and Reusable) is defeated

ORCID addresses these issues at their core.

ORCID's Place Within the African Research Ecosystem

ORCID provides three main services

1. The **ORCID iD,** a unique, persistent identifier free of charge to researchers

2. An **ORCID record**/digital cv connected to the ORCID iD, that can include employment, education, funding, peer review, research output and other metadata

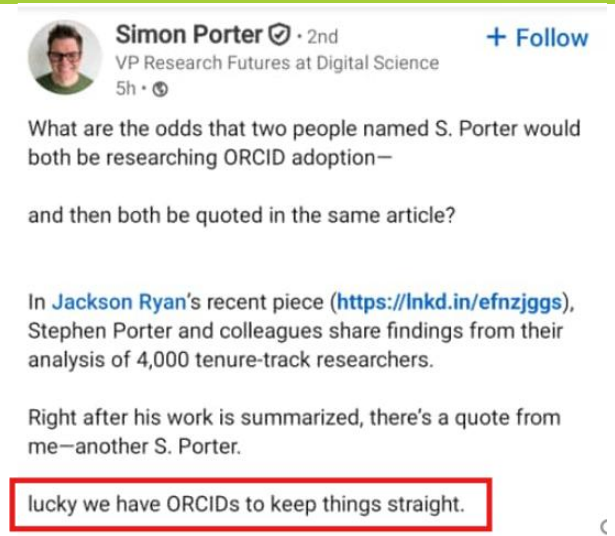
3. **Application Programming Interfaces** (APIs) as well as the services and support of communities of practice that enable interoperability between an ORCID record and member organizations

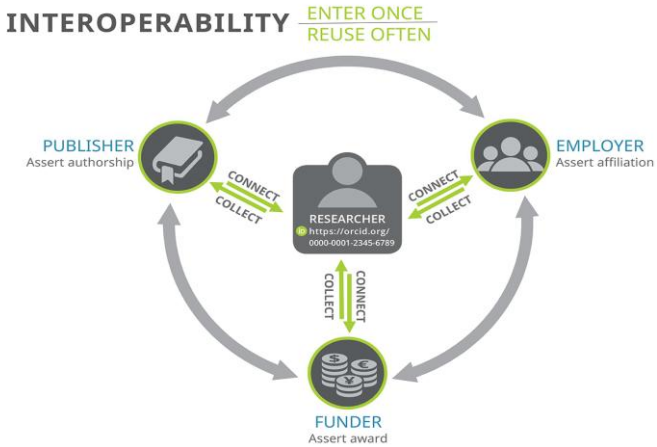
Persistent Identity in a Complex Environment

ORCID provides researchers with a **persistent digital identifier** that:

- ❖ Distinguishes them from others with similar names
- ❖ Remains constant despite institutional mobility
- ❖ Connects publications, grants, peer review, datasets, and affiliations

In Africa, where researchers often move across institutions and countries, ORCID ensures continuity of scholarly identity





Africa's Contribution to the Global Research Ecosystem

Africa is not merely integrating into global research, it is shaping it:

- Growth in open science movements
- Increased cross-border collaboration
- Expansion of regional journals and repositories
- Participation in global research funding schemes

When African researchers use ORCID:

- Their outputs are correctly attributed
- Their work becomes discoverable internationally
- Their collaboration networks become visible
- Their contributions are integrated into global metadata systems

ORCID strengthens the integrity of global scholarly records by ensuring African scholarship is not lost due to identity ambiguity or metadata fragmentation.

The Value of ORCID to Regional Maritime University (RMU)

Research Visibility and Impact

ORCID improves:

- Accurate institutional reporting
- Research impact tracking
- Global rankings data accuracy
- Showcase of institutional outputs

It ensures that our university's research contributions are properly aggregated and recognized

The Value of ORCID to Regional Maritime University (RMU)

Administrative Efficiency

ORCID reduces our administrative burden by:

- Automating publication updates
- Integrating with Journal application systems, grant and other research processes
- Streamlining thesis and dissertation submissions
- Supporting institutional repository workflows

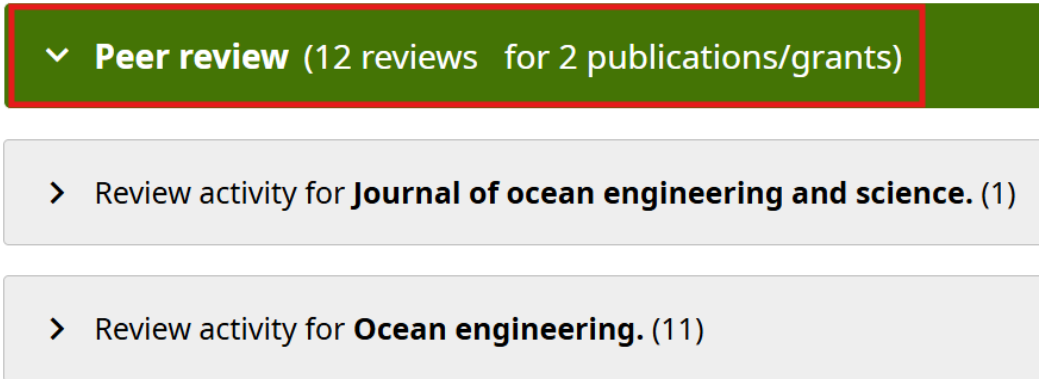
Less manual data entry means fewer errors and more reliable records.

The Value of ORCID to Regional Maritime University (RMU)

Research Integrity and Trust

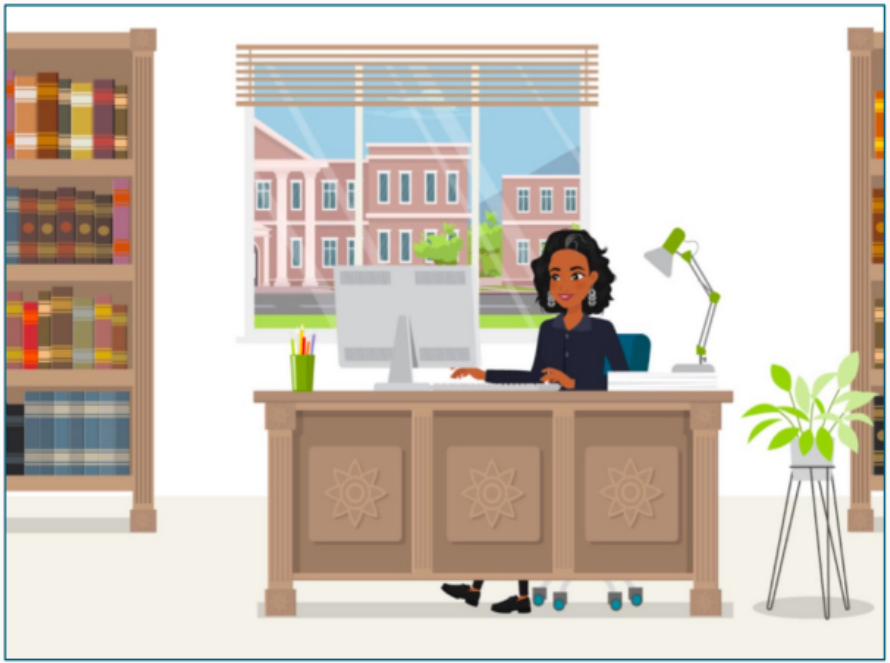
ORCID enhances:

- Transparency in authorship
- Accountability in peer review
- Clear affiliation tracking
- Trust in research metadata



This is particularly important as RMU (African institutions) increasingly engage in global partnerships and funding consortia.

When you integrate your systems with ORCID, you can more easily stay up to date with the research that comes from your scholars – while making their lives easier.



Name disambiguation. Have confidence that you have correctly identified contributions from your researchers, regardless of the popularity or variability of their names.

Better research connections. Follow your researchers' careers even after they leave your institution. Keep better track of collaborators and peers at other institutions.

Easier assessment. Effectively track the research that comes from your institution by automatically accessing authoritative trusted publication and funding data from your researchers' ORCID records.

Improved visibility of outputs. Improve the visibility of your researchers' outputs and ensure they get the recognition they deserve by automatically adding authoritative, trusted affiliation data via integration with the ORCID registry.

Reduced administrative burden. Increase both efficiency and quality in critical processes like assessment exercises. Avoid time spent re-entering data during submission, review, and reporting. When your researchers have more time to spend on research, you save money!

Strengthen research Integrity. Improve the trustworthiness of researchers' ORCID records—and contribute to the global community trust model espoused by ORCID—by adding validated data to their records.

Benefits to Researchers

For individual researchers, **ORCID** provides:

- ❖ Ownership of their scholarly record
- ❖ A portable academic identity
- ❖ Increased visibility and citation potential
- ❖ Simplified grant and manuscript submissions
- ❖ Protection against misattribution

ELSEVIER journal homepage: www.sciencedirect.com/journal/soci

Regular Article

Leisure, emotional solidarity and behavioural inter
library. the moderating roles of social identity and

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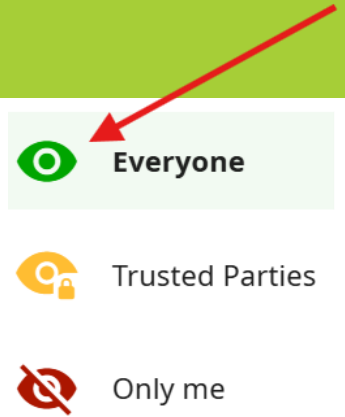
Early-career researchers especially benefit from establishing a persistent identity early in their careers.

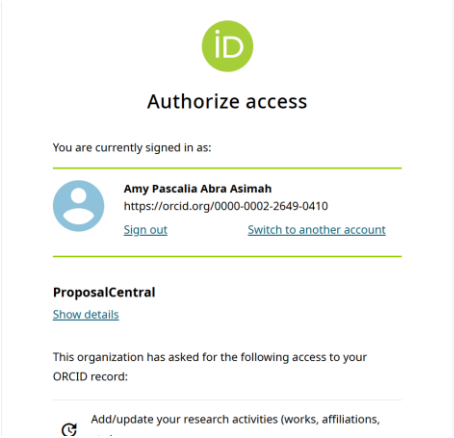
Challenges of ORCID Adoption in Africa



Individual Researchers:

- Low Awareness of the Benefits to Researchers & Institutions
- ORCID ID Duplications – Researchers with several ORCID ID's

  Remove a duplicate record
- Researchers with ORCID but invisible - Turning visibility option on
- ORCID Record not populated.
- Accepting Trusted Organisations when prompted



Institutions (Funders, Universities, Research Institutions, Publishers etc.):

- Institutional Integrations and Policy Developments
- Becoming ORCID Member Organizations (via the Power of Consortia)

Consortia Membership Benefits and Fees

2026 Fees

Member Equity Program Consortia Fees & Tiers

Lower Middle Income (LMIC) 50% reduction in fees

Min Members	Total Annual Budget of legal entity – Small Tier below$10M	Total Annual Budget of legal entity – Standard Tier $10M – $1B	Total Annual Budget of legal entity – Large Tier above $1B

Lower Income (LIC) 80% reduction in fees

Min Members	Total Annual Budget of legal entity – Small Tier below$10M	Total Annual Budget of legal entity –Standard Tier $10M – $1B	Total Annual Budget of legal entity – Large Tier above $1B

SUCCESS STORIES
Increased Statistics in ORCID Adoption in Africa

Active Researchers by Country

	Country	Active Records ↓
60	HU	26,472
61	KE	26,044
62	AE	23,849
63	GH	23,360
64	VE	22,654
65	RS	20,895
66	CU	20,596

Countries with ORCID Member Organizations

SUCCESS STORIES
CoP & Sustainability Programmes

COMMUNITIES OF PRACTICE

REGIONAL CHAMPIONS/ADVOCATES

LIBSENSE ECR - GHANA

WACREN – ORCID WACA Project

Strategic Importance for Africa

Looking forward, **ORCID** can help **Africa**:

- Strengthen continental research networks
- Improve data interoperability across institutions
- Enhance participation in global research initiatives
- Support open science and open access movements
- Improve policy-making through better research analytics

As African research output continues to grow, persistent identifiers like ORCID ensure that growth translates into measurable global impact.

Libraries as Catalysts for ORCID Adoption

University libraries are uniquely positioned to:

- Advocate for ORCID registration
- Integrate ORCID into institutional repositories
- Support researchers with profile optimization
- Collaborate with research offices and ICT departments
- Lead policy development for ORCID integration

Libraries in Africa are evolving from content custodians to **research infrastructure partners**.

Understanding ORCID in Africa

ORCID Not Just a PID (16-digit ID), it is an Enabler of:

- Equity in global scholarship
- Recognition of African research excellence
- Institutional efficiency
- Research integrity
- Bridge the gap between local research and global visibility

For Africa to fully participate in, and shape the global knowledge economy, we must invest in persistent digital identity infrastructure. ORCID is a foundational part of that investment.

Thank You!

Questions?

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